

Speaking Skills Lesson for Sales Managers

(15 Minutes)

AHK Academy

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Deadline: October 24, 2025

Focus

Improve fluency and charisma in storytelling for professional and casual settings, using simple Business English suitable for a B1 level. This lesson teaches the “Story Arc” technique, applies it through a sales-related exercise, and ends with video practice.

Step 1: Learn the Technique (5 Minutes)

Understand the Story Arc method to tell engaging stories:

- **Hook:** Start with a surprising or clear opener to grab attention.
- **Build-up:** Describe the challenge and actions using simple Business English (e.g., “We had a big problem with a client’s order”).
- **Climax:** Share the key solution or exciting moment.
- **Resolution:** End with a positive result and a lesson (e.g., “This built trust and improved our sales”).

Example Story

- **Hook:** Imagine losing a major client because of a delayed appliance delivery!
- **Build-up:** The client was upset, so we quickly checked the supply chain issues.
- **Climax:** We offered a discount and expedited shipping to save the deal.
- **Resolution:** The client stayed with us, and we learned to prioritize fast communication.

Story Arc Components

5 Hook Sentences

Simple openers to grab attention, based on home appliance sales scenarios:

- Picture a client canceling a big order because of a late delivery!
- What if one wrong product description lost a loyal customer?
- Imagine a customer upset because their new fridge arrived damaged!
- Ever had a sale almost fail due to a stock shortage?

- Think about a major deal at risk because of a pricing mistake.

5 Build-Up Sentences

Describe challenges and actions with easy Business English:

- The client was angry about a delay, so we investigated the shipping problem.
- A mix-up in the order caused confusion, and our team worked to fix it fast.
- Time was tight, so we contacted the warehouse to find a solution.
- The appliance had a defect, leading to a quick team effort to replace it.
- A pricing error upset a client, so we reviewed our process to resolve it.

5 Climax Sentences

Highlight the exciting solution or turning point:

- Then we offered a free upgrade, and the client agreed to stay!
- Our fast delivery of a replacement appliance saved the sale.
- Suddenly, a personal call to the client turned their frustration into trust.
- We found extra stock in another warehouse, securing the deal in one day!
- The new discount we offered closed the sale instantly.

5 Resolution Sentences

End with a positive result and lesson using clear Business English:

- In the end, we kept the client and increased sales by 10% with better service.
- The deal succeeded, and we learned to double-check orders for accuracy.
- Our solution built stronger client trust and improved our reputation.
- We closed the sale on time, gaining skills in quick problem-solving.
- The fix worked, and we strengthened teamwork for future sales.

Step 2: Solve and Apply (5 Minutes)

Choose a recent sales story (e.g., handling a client complaint or closing a big appliance deal). Map it to the Story Arc by writing 1-2 sentences for each part (Hook, Build-up, Climax, Resolution). Use simple Business English like “big issue,” “team effort,” or “great result.” This organizes your story for clear and confident delivery.

Example

- **Hook:** A top client threatened to switch brands over a faulty washing machine!
- **Build-up:** We listened to their concerns and checked the product issue quickly.
- **Climax:** We replaced the machine and added a free warranty in one day.
- **Resolution:** The client was thrilled, and we learned to act fast to keep trust.

Step 3: Record and Send Video (5 Minutes)

Tell your story aloud using the Story Arc. Aim for charisma with a clear voice, changing speed for excitement, and positive energy. Record a 1-2 minute video as if sharing with a colleague. Watch it to check your fluency and energy, then send it for feedback.